Blended Professional Certificate in

Chief Sustainability Officer



PROFESSIONAL EDUCATION
Digital Plus+ Programs

About the Program

Sustainability is becoming more and more prominent on corporate agendas. Once considered a matter of compliance, it is currently viewed as a key for increasing efficiency and a source of competitive advantage. 90% of executives acknowledge its importance but only 60% of companies have a sustainability strategy. Hence, there is strong need for Chief Sustainability Officers that interpret changes in the external sustainability environment, work on the strategic consequences, and define a corporate strategy to tackle them properly.

The Chief Sustainability Officer Program from MIT Professional Education provides you with the knowledge, skills, professional direction, and access you need to become a CSO.

Masterclasses and sessions led by MIT
A Faculty 2-week experience on the MIT campus

Live online synchronous sessions with experts
A total of 4 interactive sessions

Live online synchronous sessions with MIT Faculty
2 sessions per course. A total of 10 sessions

Live online synchronous sessions with learning facilitators
Weekly sessions with a total of approximately 40 sessions

Why this Program:

01 • Immersive 12-month learning that will enable senior executives to become successful Chief Sustainability Officers.

02 • Comprehensive learning journey where you will acquire the technical knowledge and develop the right mindset and leadership skills to lead transformation and growth based on technology, data, and innovation.

03 • Live online sessions with MIT Faculty, subject matter experts and guest speakers leading digital transformation initiatives.

04 • Experiential in-person at the MIT Campus where you will have direct contact and attend hands-on workshops with MIT faculty members, speakers, and colleagues.

05 • Access to the Digital Pathway which includes over 90 webinars in diverse topics and industry themes from experts.

06 • Personalized coaching sessions with coaches that will help you define your career goals and set up a plan to progress accordingly.

07 • Access to a premium ecosystem and network composed of MIT Faculty, leading executives in digital transformation and senior executives from all around the world.

08 • Become part of the MIT community, the leading institution in the World for Innovation and Digital Transformation.

Key Takeaways

Throughout this professional program, you will:

01 Understand what sustainability is, its root causes and how to measure it through different techniques.

02 Formulate cogent, rigorous positions, and arguments to make sustainability decisions within your organization.

03 Elaborate pragmatic strategies that can be employed across different sectors to bolster sustainability.

04 Learn how to implement life-cycle sustainability assessments (LCSAs) to identify and develop new methods for boosting sustainability.

05 Understand the meaning and evolution of a circular economy and the roles of material science, economic and institutional structures, and technology.

06 Acquire the required leadership skills to drive and implement the sustainability agenda in your company.

Participant Profile

Directors, VPs and entrepreneurs responsible for product design, engineering, or marketing

Current product leaders and aspiring C-suite executives who want to keep current on trends to accelerate growth

Senior executives looking to align product strategy with business strategy and understand the implications of technology on the product portfolio

Participants are required to have:

- A minimum of ten years of experience working in a managerial position
- At least 3 years of experience managing projects related to strategy management
- International experience is appreciated

Learning Journey

Program Outline

Module 1 | **Leadership & Innovation**
8 weeks

With this module, participants will learn to lead by coming to know themselves better, harnessing their own creativity, and building teams and organizations through the culture of innovation.

Module 2 | **Sustainability: Strategies and Opportunities for Industry**
8 weeks

The time to act is upon us, and increased focus on sustainability provides businesses with significant benefits, from reductions in waste and costs to additional opportunities for investment as consumer behavior evolves.

Module 3 | **Life Cycle Assessment**
8 weeks

This module will provide a foundation for conducting and interpreting LCAs, following the approach defined in international standards. The steps include goal and scope definition, life cycle inventory, life cycle impact assessment, and interpretation.

Module 4 | **Sustainable Infrastructure Systems: Planning and Operations**
8 weeks

You will explore systems theory as the basis for analysis, development, and engineering of sustainable, adaptable technological systems. This module will equip you with the knowledge and skills needed to develop modern sustainable infrastructure, from public policy and planning to operational management and data collection.

Module 5 | **Circular Economy**
9 weeks

This module provides a fundamental understanding of the meaning and evolution of a circular economy with the role of material science, economics, and institutional methods. Explore innovation and evolution with a focus on circular economies at the corporate level, through specific examples like water, metals and waste recycling, and others.

Impact Project

A crucial aspect of the program enables you to apply your learnings to a real-world challenge as you gain insights into the opportunities awaiting a Chief Sustainability Officer.

1 Premium Access / MIT Professional Education ecosystem

Get exclusive access to networking events, live online sessions with speakers and international MIT Alumni network.

2 Professional Development

In turn, you will have the support of a specialized career development coach who will help you enhance and elevate your professional career.

3 Access to the Digital Pathway

Includes over 90 webinars on diverse topics and industry themes. That is around 5520 minutes of expert knowledge.

Meet the Faculty

In alphabetical order



Prof. John E. Fernández

Professor of Building Technology Program in the Department of Architecture and Director of MIT Environmental Solutions Initiative



Dr. Jeremy Gregory

Executive Director, MIT Climate and Sustainability Consortium



Dr. David Niño

Senior Lecturer in the Daniel J. Riccio Graduate Engineering Leadership Program at MIT



Prof. Elsa Olivetti

Esther and Harold E. Edgerton associate professor in Materials Science and Engineering at MIT



Dr. Afreen Siddiqi

Research Scientist, MIT and Adjunct Lecturer in Public Policy, Harvard Kennedy School



Prof. Olivier de Weck

Professor of Aeronautics, Astronautics and Engineering Systems, MIT

MIT Professional Education Alumni



At MIT Professional Education, we offer several benefits for participants who successfully complete the Blended Professional Certificate: Chief Sustainability Officer

01 Professional Certificate and CEUs

02 Access to our exclusive Virtual Campus Network and directory for online alumni

03 Exclusive announcements of new courses, programs, and events.

04 Access to our exclusive MIT Professional Education LinkedIn group

05 International Networking opportunities with other MIT Professional Education alumni

06 15% discount for online programs and short duration, in-person programs offered by MIT Professional Education

07 A one-year subscription to MIT Technology Review

About MIT Professional Education

MIT Professional Education provides continuing education courses and lifelong learning opportunities for science, engineering, and technology professionals at all levels, from around the world. Worthy of note is that MIT professors and lecturers lead and teach all MIT Professional Education offerings.

